

JULY 2026

Pacing the Frontier

A statement from **1,178** employees of
frontier AI companies

SIGNATORIES

COMMENTS

Statement

AI could help create a dramatically better future, but that outcome is not guaranteed. The world's leading AI companies believe they could be close to automating AI research. It is hard to predict exactly how much this will accelerate AI progress, but there is a real risk that capability development rapidly accelerates beyond our ability to understand or control the resulting systems.

To realize AI's potential, industry, government, and society at large may need the option to buy time to address emerging risks, develop security measures, and strengthen oversight. But each company—and country—is under intense competitive pressure not to unilaterally slow that acceleration. And today, the world lacks the technical and governance tools to deliberately pace frontier-wide progress.

Building on work already underway to monitor frontier model releases:

We request that the U.S. government support an international effort to

we request that the U.S. government support an international effort to develop the technical and governance tools needed to deliberately pace the frontier of automated AI development.”

- 1,178 employees of frontier AI companies

Signatories

(20/1,178)

John Schulman

Chief Scientist, Thinking Machines



Jakub Pachocki

Chief Scientist, OpenAI

Jared Kaplan

Co-Founder and Chief Science Officer, Anthropic

Shengjia Zhao

Chief Scientist, Meta AI



Mark Chen

Chief Research Officer, OpenAI

Jasjeet Sekhon

Chief Strategy Officer, Google DeepMind

Dario Amodei

CEO, Anthropic

Jack Clark

Co-Founder and Head of Public Benefit, Anthropic

Anca Dragan

VP, AI Safety & Alignment, Google

Wojciech Zaremba

Head of AI Resilience, OpenAI Foundation

Dawn Song

VP, AI Research, Meta



Chris Olah

Co-Founder & Interpretability Research Lead, Anthropic

Laura Weidinger

Staff Research Scientist, Google



Benjamin Mann

Co-Founder, Anthropic

Stephanie Chan

Staff Research Scientist, Google



Julian Schrittwieser

Anthropic

Summer Yue

Director of Alignment and Risk, Meta

Jan Leike

Anthropic

Boaz Barak

OpenAI

Mike Krieger

Member of Technical Staff, Anthropic

SHOW MORE

Personal Comments

(9/78)

All comments are made in a personal capacity and do not necessarily represent any company's views.

"The world is locked in a deadly race towards an intelligence explosion, where AI's ability to create better AIs reaches a critical point, just like a runaway nuclear chain reaction. Going slower would give us much-needed time to make it go well, but no individual actor is willing to stop unilaterally. To survive, we must coordinate to slow down the race."

Leo Gao

Member of Technical Staff, OpenAI

"Even after 3 years working on AI capability evaluations, the recent pace of

Even after 5 years working on AI capability evaluations, the recent pace of progress has been a shock. To avoid catastrophic harms from AGI, we need much, much better coordination."

Matthew Rahtz

Staff Research Engineer, Google

"As a foreign national, I see a US-supported effort as existential, not only for the liberties of the free world but for the prosperity of all."

Christian Ryan

Member of Technical Staff, Anthropic

"Like splitting the atom, AI holds the potential for both immense benefit and immense risk. The world should take the time to do this right."

Will Yager

Anthropic

"At the current pace, every couple of weeks there will be new models which significantly increase the consequences of model misuse and misalignment. I worry that efforts to mitigate these risks may fail to keep up with the pace of development, and that margins for error will become increasingly small under international competitive pressures. In the near future, we may urgently want to enact an..." [Show more](#)

Micah Carroll

Misalignment Preparedness, OpenAI

"AI is progressing at a rate that our society might not be ready for. Frontier labs are very close to AI that can exceed even the best people on almost every metric of intelligence. This will lead to unprecedented social and safety risks. To ensure a positive future we need to develop AI in a way that is driven by responsibility and thoughtfulness."

Shengjia Zhao

Chief Scientist, Meta AI

"Signed because this statement helps establish common knowledge about the possible need for coordination mechanisms as automated AI research accelerates progress. I'd also like to see labs start designing these mechanisms voluntarily, even before the USG gets involved."

John Schulman

Chief Scientist, Thinking Machines

"In the span of four years, we have gone from people having their first experience of an AI that could understand language, to AI that is performing superhuman feats of software engineering, making frontier math breakthroughs, and accelerating scientific research. Progress has shown no signs of slowing down and by default it is in the interest of individual corporations and countries to push the..." [Show more](#)

Shantanu Jain

Member of Technical Staff, OpenAI

"As Melvin Kranzberg wrote, technology is neither good nor bad; nor is it neutral. Achieving societal benefit depends on understanding the interdependent ways in which many humans use advanced AI systems in concert, understanding that takes time to acquire.

Pacing progress towards automated AI research allows us the time to build understanding of societal-scale changes, yielding not only an..."

[Show more](#)

Edward Hughes

Chief Scientist, Inherent

SHOW MORE

Sign

If you are an employee at a frontier AI company, you can sign the letter [here](#).

To be verified, you must sign using your corporate email or otherwise provide proof of employment.

This statement was published by
employees of frontier AI companies,
with organizational support from two
independent nonprofits, Guidelight AI
Standards and Encode AI.

Press and other inquiries:
contact@pacingthefrontier.com

[Privacy Policy](#)

[BACK TO TOP](#)